Global Layoffs Analysis (2020–2023)

Project to analyze global layoff trends across industries, locations, and company stages — identifying causes and the funding–layoff relationship.

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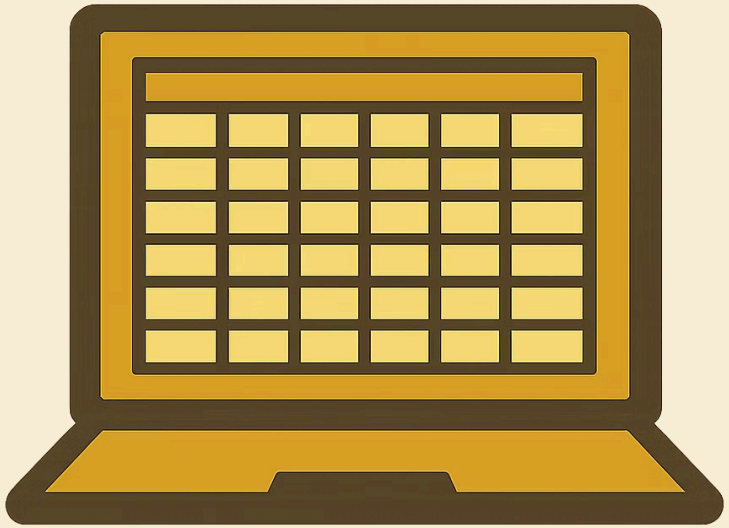

Dataset Summary

Scope

1932 rows × 9 columns: company, industry, location, total_laid_off, percentage, date, stage, country, funds_raised_millions.

Primary Focus

Trends by industry, geography, and company stage; causes of mass layoffs and correlation with funding.

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Data Cleaning: Overview

Cleaned and standardized records in MySQL: removed duplicates, normalized industry names, treated nulls, and converted text dates to DATE for time-series analysis.

Duplicates

Used ROW_NUMBER() partitioning to detect and delete duplicate rows.

Standardization

Merged variants (e.g., "CryptoCurrency" → "Crypto") and trimmed whitespace.

Date Conversion

Converted text dates using STR_TO_DATE and altered column to DATE.

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SQL Snippets (Key Steps)

```
CREATE TABLE layoffs_staging3 (..., row_num INT);
INSERT INTO layoffs_staging3 SELECT *, ROW_NUMBER()
OVER(PARTITION BY company, location, industry, total_laid_off,
percentage_laid_off, date, stage, country, funds_raised_millions) AS
row_num FROM layoffs_staging;
DELETE FROM layoffs_staging3 WHERE row_num > 1;
UPDATE layoffs_staging3 SET industry='Crypto' WHERE industry LIKE
'Crypto%';
```

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Top Layoff Events (Largest Single Events)

1

Google

12,000 laid off — 2023-01-20

2

Meta

11,000 laid off — 2022-11-09

3

Microsoft

10,000 laid off — 2023-01-18

4

Amazon

10,000 laid off — 2022-11-16

5

Ericsson

8,500 laid off — 2023-02-24

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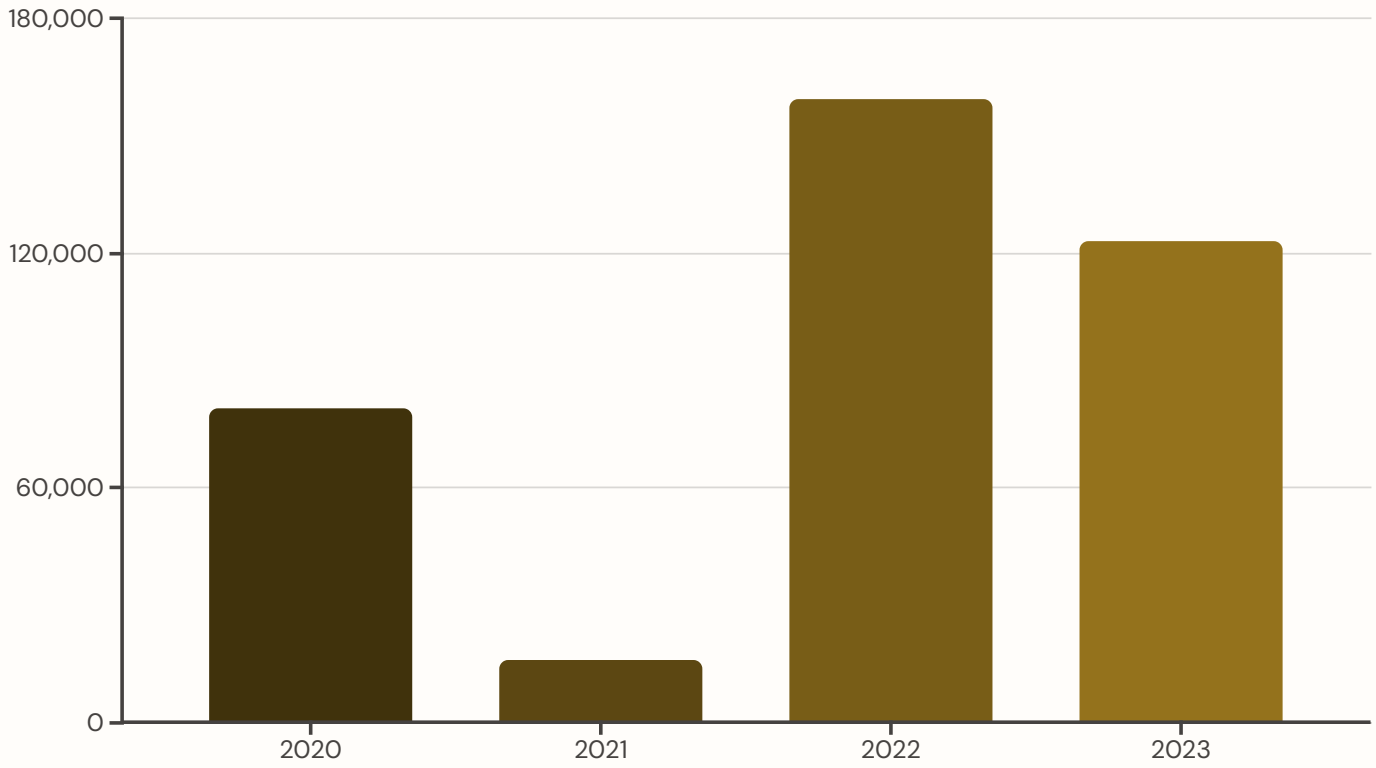
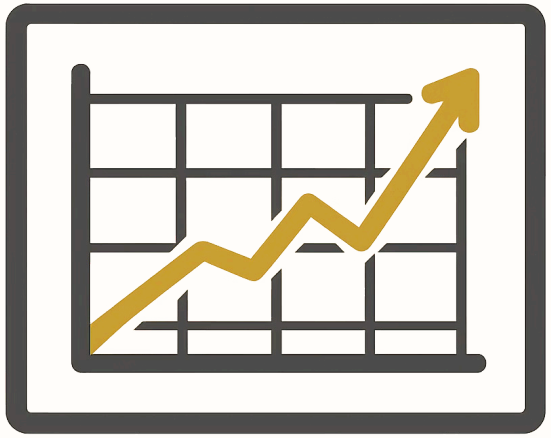
Yearly Impact



The dataset shows a major peak in 2022, a higher cumulative impact than the initial 2020 pandemic surge. Use these yearly totals to prioritize response and monitoring.



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Vulnerability by Company Stage

Post-IPO

202,266 layoffs — the largest share of major events.

Unknown / Private

39,907 layoffs classified as unknown; startups and private firms also heavily impacted.

Acquired / Subsidiary

27,130 layoffs among acquired companies and 1,014 in subsidiaries.

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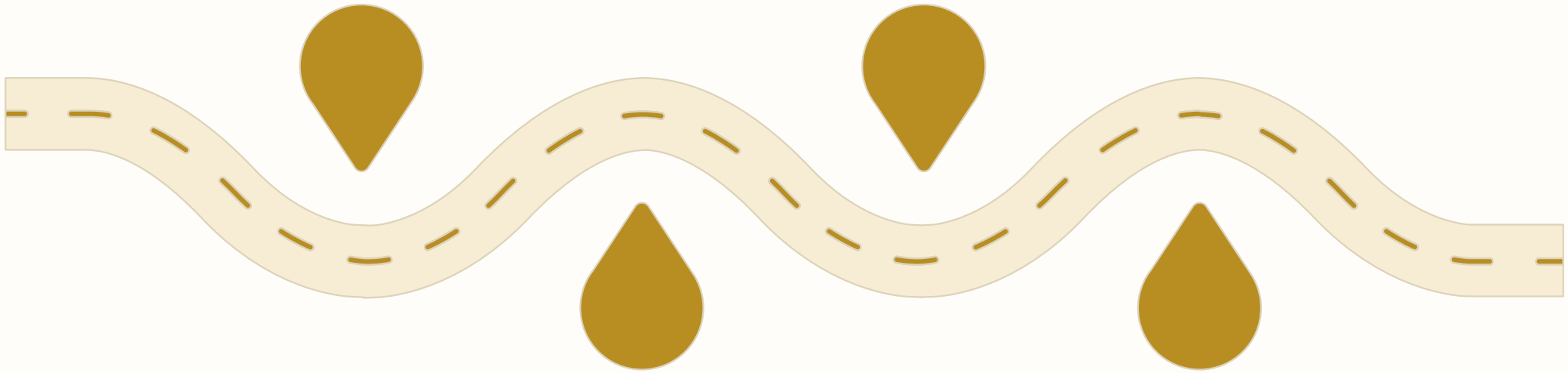
Rolling Totals (Monthly)



Monthly and cumulative perspective highlights acceleration in late 2022 and early 2023 — useful for detecting inflection points.

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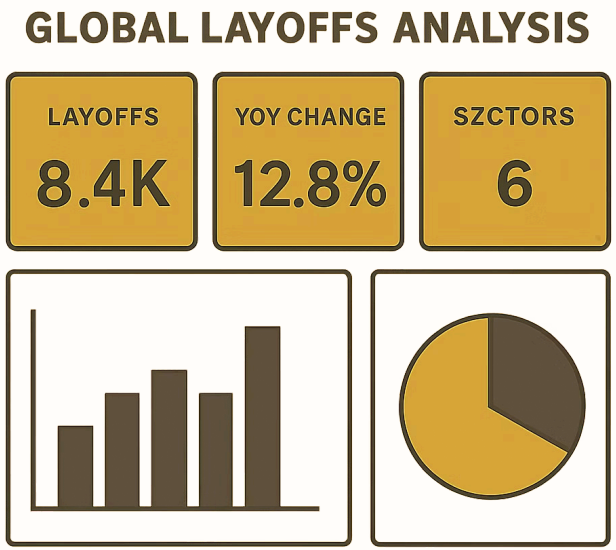
Interactive Dashboard Snapshot

Tableau dashboard summarizing KPIs, yearly trends, industry breakdowns, world map of events, top companies, and funding vs. layoffs scatter plot.

- Total Laid Off: 379,341
- Total Companies: 1,577
- Most Impacted Industry: Consumer (45,042)
- Peak Year: 2022



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Conclusions & Recommendations

1

Project Summary

Cleaned MySQL dataset and visualized trends to reveal industry, stage, and funding patterns from 2020–2023.

2

Key Findings

Peak in late 2022–early 2023; Retail & Consumer hardest hit; high funding did not prevent mass layoffs; Post-IPO firms drove largest events.

3

Recommendations

Favor sustainable hiring, diversify employee skills, deploy proactive dashboards for early warning, and build stronger cash reserves.

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